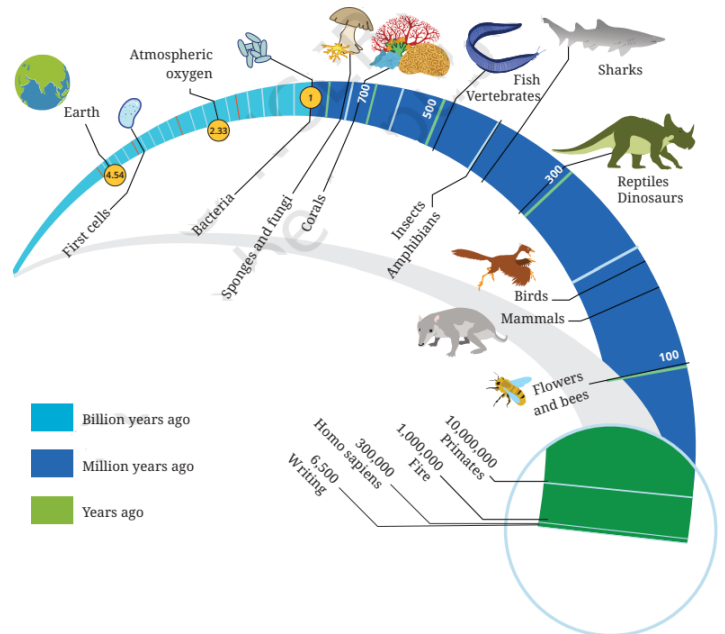


Chapter – 4: Timeline and Sources of History

History is “an unending dialogue between the present and the past ... between the society of today and the society of yesterday. ... We can fully understand the present only in the light of the past.” — E.H. Carr

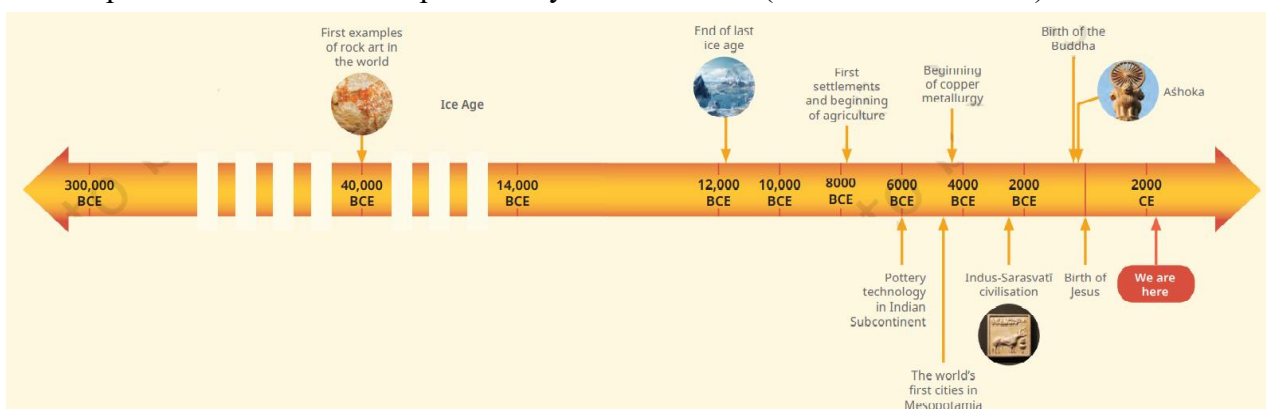
How do We Learn About the Past?

- Earth – very, very long history – humans – very tiny part – the most recent one
- Many people – study history of Earth
- Some – trained – uncover – secrets – beneath Earth’s surface
- Obs. 4 pictures –
 - **Geologists** – study – phy. features – soil, stones, hills, mountains, rivers, seas, oceans, etc.
 - **Paleontologists** – study – remains – plants, animals, humans – millions of years ago - **fossils**
 - **Anthropologists** – study – human societies, cultures – oldest times to present
 - **Archaeologists** – study – past – digging – remains – left behind – tools, pots, beads, figurines, toys, bones, teeth, burnt grains, parts of houses, bricks, etc.



How is Time Measured in History?

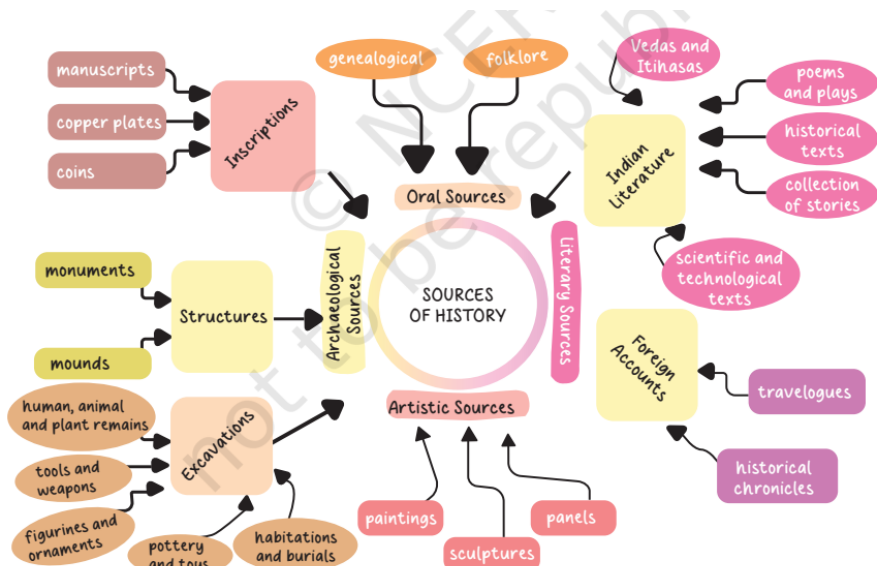
- Each society, culture – own way – measure time
- Major events – birth of imp. person – OR – start of a ruler’s reign – marked as – beginning of new **era**
- Present time – **Gregorian calendar** – common – worldwide
- Also – Hindu, Muslim, Jewish, Chinese calendar – also used – calculate – dates – festivals and **auspicious** events
- West – conventional yr. – Jesus Christ’s birth – generally – starting pt.
- Yrs. – counted fwd. – this pt. – marked with AD (abbr. – Latin phrase – Anno Domini – meaning – after Jesus’ birth)
- Now – called – **common era** (CE)
- Example – 1947 – Indian Independence year – 1947 AD (sometimes AD 1947) OR 1947 CE



- Yrs. – before Jesus' birth – counted backwards – marked with BC (Before Christ)
- Now – called – **before common era** (BCE)
- Example – 560 BCE – Gautam Buddha – birth yr.
- Gregorian calendar – no '0 yr.' – yr. 1 BCE – followed directly by – yr. 1 CE
- Calculations – 2 BCE to 2 CE – $2 + 2 - 1 = 3$ yrs.
- **Timeline** – convenient tool – mark events – shows – sequence of dates, events – cover – any particular period
- Dotted portion – skipped period – otherwise – timeline – 3 meters long
- Timeline – helps – understanding order – history events – take place
- Example – without dates – you know – birth of Buddha – before birth of Jesus
- Yr. and decade (10 yrs.) – other terms – longer time durations –
 - **Century** – 100 yrs.
 - Centuries CE –
 - Counted every 100 yrs. – starting from 1 CE
 - Present – 21st century CE – 2001 to 2100 CE
 - Centuries BCE –
 - Counted every 100 yrs. – starting from 1 BCE – going backwards
 - Example – 3rd century BCE – 300 BCE to 201 BCE
 - **Millennium** – 1000 yrs.
 - Millennium CE –
 - Counted every 1000 yrs. – starting from 1 CE
 - Present – 3rd Millennium CE – 2001 to 3000 CE
 - Millennium BCE –
 - Counted every 1000 yrs. – starting from 1 BCE – going backwards
 - Example – 1st Millennium BCE – 1 BCE to 1000 BCE

What are the Sources of History?

- Activity –
 - Collect info. – 3 generations – father's and mother's side
 - Create – family tree – info. – name, occupation, place of birth, etc.
- How – found out – details – family's past?
- Did you rely on – photos, diaries, IDs, memories, etc.
- Every obj., structure – story – like a piece – jigsaw puzzle
- Obj. around house – convey – history of family
- Similarly – put together – history events – variety of src.
- In case of history – many pieces – remain missing
- Img. – src. of history – study some now and some other time



- **Historians** – study – king or queen – 1500 yrs. ago – ancient monument – war – OR – some trade – take great care – gather info. – as many src. as available
- Sometimes – src. – confirm each other – other times – src. – contradictory (opp.) info. – decide – which src. – more trustable
- This is how – re-create – history of any period
- Who contribute – these src.?
- Historians, archaeologists, epigraphists, anthropologists, experts – literature, language, etc.
- Last 50 yrs. – scientific studies – contribute – reconstruction of past
- Example – studies – ancient climates, excavated material, **genetics** – fresh insights – supplement – usual src.
- Recent history –
 - 2 to 3 centuries – src. – newspapers
 - Last few decades – electronic media

The Beginnings of Human History

- Modern humans – *Homo Sapiens* – last 3,00,000 yrs.
- Looks – very long – BUT – only tiny part – Earth's history
- Early humans – many challenges – lived in bands (grp.) – help each other
- Seek – shelter and food – mainly hunters and gatherers – hunting and collecting edible plants and fruits
- Early ancestors – certain beliefs – natural element – AND – some notion – **afterlife**
- These grp. – lived in temporary camps, rock shelters, caves – communicated – languages – now lost
- Used fire – made obj. – made lives easier – stone axes, blades, arrowheads, etc.
- Aspects of lives – visible – rock paintings – hundreds of caves
- Some paintings – simple figures (symbols) – others – more detailed – scenes – animals, humans
- In time – early humans – learned – simple ornaments – stone (shell) beads, pendants – animal teeth – sometimes – exchanged – another grp.



The First Crops

- Long ages – Earth's climate – many changes
- Certain times – very cold – entire Earth – covered with ice – Ice Age
- Later – climate – warmed up – ice – melted – resulting water – swelled – existing rivers – drained into oceans
- Last Ice Age – 1,00,000 yrs. ago to 12,000 yrs. ago
- Afterwards – living conditions – improved – humans – settled down – started cultivating – cereals and grains
- Also – domesticated animals – cattle, goats, etc.
- Food availability – increased – communities grew – size and number – settled down – near rivers
- This settlement – availability of water – BUT ALSO – fertile soil – growing crops – easier
- Communities grew – social complexity increased

- Leaders (chieftains) – responsible – well-being of their people – everyone together – worked for community's **welfare**
- Example – no individual ownership – lands – collectively sowed and harvested
- Time went by – hamlets – small settlement – grew – large villages – exchanged goods – food, clothing and tools
- Slowly – networks of communication and exchange – estd. – some – grew into towns
- New technology – pottery, use of metal, etc.
- Early progress – humanity – many challenges
- Some critical times – humanity – almost disappeared – like some earlier species